



How to get donated equipment?

Created	@30 de julio de 2025 15:54
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Giving a second use to equipment that would otherwise be discarded.

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Related solutions

Giving a second use to equipment that would otherwise be discarded.

Welcome

Hello, are you there? My name is Mateo and I will accompany you in the development of this solution. If you are reading, listening or watching this is because you are interested or curious about how to get donated equipment. If so, you are in the right place.

What is getting donated equipment?

Simply put, this solution is about reuse. It speaks of being consistent with the care of the world in which we live, it

speaks of taking advantage of things that for others are obsolete, but that we can use, perhaps, much longer.

This solution serves to give a second chance to equipment that is no longer needed. Did you know that there are companies that want to change their equipment and donate the ones they have? This equipment is usually in good condition and your community could take advantage of it.

What is this solution for?

While this solution does not require money for the purchase of equipment, keep in mind that this solution can take weeks, even months, depending on the steps we will tell you about below. On the other hand, you have a better chance of receiving a donation if you demonstrate that the use of the equipment will be community-based and that its purpose is to improve people's quality of life.

What do you need?

- Persistence.
- Patience.
- Seek support from others. Teamwork increases your chances.

How to do it?

Let's start!

This solution is composed of three steps in which we will tell you everything we know and have learned at Fundación SOLE Colombia about how to get donated equipment. All cases are different, so it is important that you are willing to adapt these steps depending on the difficulties you encounter along the way.

▼ Step 1: Search for potential donors



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Generally, equipment donors are companies with large financial capacity, payroll and infrastructure. Think of telephone or computer companies, universities, or find out about sponsors of social projects in your region. However, we suggest you start with small companies. For this you have two options: **Option 1. Direct search:** you can search for companies or people who donate equipment through the internet, social networks, consulting with your contact networks or close circles.

For option 1, make a list of the companies and the ways you have to contact them, it can be through the people who manage the finances of the organization or those who manage the computer equipment, the important thing is to get a direct contact of the donor company with whom you can talk in person, send an email, a call or a letter. If you send them a letter or mail, make sure they will read it and, if they are not responsible for making the decision, make sure they will forward it to the person they need.

Option 2. Dissemination: you can write a message or announcement in social networks making it explicit that: 1. you need donated equipment in good condition; 2. you have a community project in which many people will benefit; 3. write the number where they can contact you; 4. make it clear who you are and make sure the message arouses empathy and trust. An example of a message could be:

"Hello everyone! My name is Amaranta and I am part of the XYZ FOUNDATION. Does anyone know of organizations that are donating computer equipment in good condition? We are looking for support to implement a project with older adults in rural areas of Colombia. Any information or contact would be of great help, thank you! My contact number is 123456789"

We suggest you do both options at the same time, this will broaden the possibilities you have to find a donor company.

Be courageous! At this point it is key that you are persistent. This does not have a magic formula, it is a matter of knocking on doors and opening paths. In any case, if you have read or listened this far, it is because you already have the will to do it and I admire that.

▼ **Moment 2: Find the donor company and identify the relationship model.**



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Once you have sent the requests you just have to wait and insist continuously to receive a response. Don't let the contact go cold, if more than a week goes by without a response, write again or go in person if possible. When you get an affirmative answer, be clear about the model in which you will receive the equipment: not all companies donate their equipment, some decide to give it away, so there are two types of models:

Option 1. Gift of equipment: you may find a company or person who gives away their equipment. Relatives may give away equipment. When you contact them, make sure that you will indeed receive the equipment in this way.

Option 2. Equipment donation: Now, for the case of companies that donate is a different model in which a second chance is given to equipment that are in good condition and that can be used by people and communities that need them. How does it work? Many companies have to make upgrades that require changing their equipment or need

new technologies to carry out their work, so they decide to donate and thus can receive a tax deduction. It is important to note that in order for this to be possible, donating companies need to receive a donation certificate. If you are not part of a foundation, you should find an ally that can make this certificate for you. Who and how is this certificate issued for companies that want to donate? To get an ally think of a non-profit entity that has an active legal figure and can issue these certificates for the companies that will donate the equipment. For example, foundations, cooperatives or similar entities in your region. Talk to them and tell them about your purpose. If they decide to support you, ask them for guidance in this process.

We invite you to look up the story of Alex Cortés, an engineer who founded Click Foundation with the objective of giving a second life to computers that many people, organizations or companies no longer need; he decides to repair them, maintain them and give them away or donate them to those who need them most. If you want to know more about his story, we invite you to search about him, his foundation and his history.

Important: you must be clear about how the equipment will be used, since legally the equipment will belong to the ally you got. Don't forget to check that the equipment you will receive is functional. We do not want you to end up storing technological garbage that you will have to repair.

▼ Moment 3: Receiving the equipment and building a relationship



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For the reception of the equipment, in either mode, keep in mind that each company or person has its own procedure. The delivery of the equipment may be a shipment, you may have to pick it up or make an agreement about the place of delivery with the company or person who will make the donation. After the delivery, it is important to know what kind of relationship you want and can build with them:

Option 1. Equipment gift: for this option, no paperwork is usually needed to formalize receipt; however, those giving the equipment may want to build a short- to medium-term relationship, know how you will use the equipment and for what purpose. If not, make it explicit and maintain a good relationship with them. When equipment is given as a gift, paperwork is usually not necessary, however, from the SOLE Colombia Foundation, for example, we make a letter with thanks and signatures between the parties corroborating the delivery of equipment, its condition and the good use we will make of it.

Option 2. Equipment donation: For the delivery, make a donation request explaining your interests, conditions and the cooperation you will build. How much equipment do you need? What is the condition of the equipment you will receive? What does the donor company need from you? What will you use the equipment for? Who will be the people and communities that will benefit? For this option, we suggest that, as in option 1, you consider the possibility of building a relationship with the donor company. At the SOLE Colombia Foundation, we usually send the donor companies photographs that thank them and show evidence of the community use of the equipment, thus opening up the possibility of future donations.

5. What does the community use of the equipment imply?

Remember what we mentioned at the beginning of this solution about the possibilities of receiving a donation if you demonstrate that the use of the equipment will be communal? Now we invite you to reflect on the importance of the collective use of the equipment in a community. It is not only about receiving them, but also about reaching agreements on who will manage them, how they will use them and how often; this will imply fostering dialogue and teamwork. It is not about having a lot of equipment, but about knowing how to use it in community.

See you soon! We invite you to investigate other solutions and to keep on tinkering.

6. Recommended solutions

We invite you to read the solution on Team Governance.

7. Suggestions

- If you want to know more, click here to read the press release made by El Tiempo newspaper in 2016.
- <https://www.gestionandote.org/donacion-de-computadores-para-desarrollo-de-proyectos-sociales/>

How to know if this solution works?

When you receive equipment that others do not use, you have proven that this solution works. You will also have created a relationship with someone, that's nice and powerful. Someone who has tuned into your purpose and wants to lend you a hand.

Why might this solution work?

Maybe this relationship is a long term one, can you imagine that every year they can donate a few computers to you, what would you do with all that equipment? Thinking about how you can extend that blanket to others is one way to make this world a fairer place. If you want to know what we at SOLE

Colombia do with the computers that are donated to us, take a look at www.solecolombia.org

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